



Leadership & Influence: The Executive Playbook

Your comprehensive handbook for leading teams and driving results. This workbook contains the leadership frameworks that Fortune 500 executives use to build high-performing teams, drive organizational change, and create lasting impact.





From Manager to Leader

1

The Critical Distinction

This course is not about managing people. It's about leading them. There's a difference. Managers maintain the status quo. Leaders create the future.

2

This workbook is your transformation guide—the exercises within will elevate you from someone who manages tasks to someone who inspires teams, drives vision, and creates movements.

3

Execute these exercises. Your career depends on it.



The Leadership Mindset: Who You Must Become

Leadership is not a title. It's a way of being. Before you can lead others, you must lead yourself. Before you can inspire change, you must embody it. This section is about the internal transformation that precedes external results.

Internal Transformation

Master self-leadership before leading others. Your personal growth drives organizational impact.

Embodied Change

Become the change you want to see. Authenticity creates magnetic leadership presence.

External Results

Your internal work manifests as measurable team performance and business outcomes.

The 3 Levels of Leadership Maturity



Level 1: Positional Leadership

People follow you because they have to. Your authority comes from your title. You manage through control and compliance.



Level 2: Relational Leadership

People follow you because they want to. Your authority comes from trust and respect. You lead through influence and inspiration.



Level 3: Transformational Leadership

People follow you because of who you help them become. Your authority comes from vision and empowerment. You lead through purpose and possibility.

Your Goal: Operate at Level 3 in every interaction. This is where legacy is built. This is where movements begin.





Leadership Maturity Assessment

1

Current Level Assessment

Where are you now?

Circle one: Positional, Relational, Transformational

2

Supporting Evidence

What evidence supports this assessment?

3

Growth Barriers

What is holding you back from the next level?

4

The One Thing

What is the one leadership behavior you can develop this month to level up?



The Vision Framework: Leading with Purpose

Leaders without vision are managers with titles. Vision is what separates those who maintain from those who transform. Your vision is your North Star—it guides decisions, inspires action, and attracts talent.

1

Where We Are

Honest assessment of current reality (no sugarcoating)

2

Where We're Going

Compelling picture of the future state (specific and inspiring)

3

Why It Matters

The purpose that makes the journey meaningful (emotional connection)

Craft Your Team Vision



Where We Are (Current Reality)



Where We're Going (Future State)



Why It Matters (Purpose)

☐ Your Vision Statement (combine all three):





The Trust Equation: The Foundation of Influence

Without trust, you have compliance, not commitment. Without trust, you have employees, not disciples. Trust is the currency of leadership. You earn it slowly and lose it instantly. Guard it fiercely.



Credibility

Do you know what you're talking about?
(Competence)



Reliability

Do you do what you say you'll do? (Consistency)



Intimacy

Do you care about your people? (Connection)



Self-Orientation

Are you serving yourself or serving others? (Motive)

The Trust Equation™

Trust = (Credibility + Reliability + Intimacy) ÷ Self-Orientation

The lower your self-orientation, the higher your trust.



Your Trust Audit

Rate yourself 1-10 on each dimension and identify concrete actions to improve your leadership trust factor.

Credibility (Competence)

Your Score: _____

What evidence supports this score?

How can you increase it?

Reliability (Consistency)

Your Score: _____

What evidence supports this score?

How can you increase it?

Intimacy (Connection)

Your Score: _____

What evidence supports this score?

How can you increase it?

Self-Orientation (Motive)

Your Score: _____

What evidence supports this score?

How can you decrease it?

Your Trust Score:

(Credibility + Reliability + Intimacy) ÷ Self-Orientation = _____

The Communication Hierarchy: Leading Through Words

Great leaders are great communicators. Not because they're eloquent—because they're clear. Clarity is kindness. Ambiguity is cruelty. Your team cannot execute what they don't understand.

Clear

Simple language. No jargon. No ambiguity.



Consistent

Same message, multiple channels, repeated often.



Compelling

Connects to emotion, purpose, and personal benefit.



Communicate Your Next Initiative



What is the initiative?



Why does it matter? (Connect to purpose)



What's in it for them? (Personal benefit)



What do you need them to do? (Clear action)

☐ Your Communication (use the 3 Cs):



The Delegation Framework: Multiplying Your Impact



Leaders who can't delegate can't scale. If you're the bottleneck, you're not a leader—you're a highly paid individual contributor. Delegation is not dumping tasks. It's developing people.

Level 1: Do and Report

"Do exactly what I say and report back."

Level 2: Research and Recommend

"Research options and recommend a course of action."

Level 3: Decide and Inform

"Make the decision and let me know what you decided."

Level 4: Act Independently

"You own this. I trust your judgment."

Match the delegation level to the person's competence and commitment.



Delegation Audit

List 5 tasks you're currently doing that you should delegate. Be honest—your time is your most valuable asset.

Task	Who Should Own It?	Delegation Level?
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-----	-----	-----
-----	-----	-----
-----	-----	-----
-----	-----	-----

The Feedback Formula: Developing Your People

Feedback is the breakfast of champions. Without it, your team operates in the dark. But most leaders avoid feedback because they confuse it with criticism. Feedback is a gift. Criticism is an attack. Learn the difference.

1

S - Situation

Describe the specific situation (when and where)

2

B - Behavior

Describe the observable behavior (what they did or said)

3

I - Impact

Describe the impact of that behavior (how it affected results or people)

The SBI Feedback Model™

Example: "In yesterday's client meeting (Situation), you interrupted the client three times (Behavior), which made them visibly frustrated and we lost the deal (Impact)."





Practice Giving Feedback

Think of someone on your team who needs feedback. Use the SBI model to structure your message with precision and care.

1

Situation (when and where):

2

Behavior (what they did or said):

3

Impact (how it affected results or people):



Your Complete Feedback Statement:

The Decision-Making Matrix: Leading with Clarity

Leaders make decisions. That's the job. But most leaders agonize over decisions because they lack a framework. Decision-making is not about being right every time—it's about being decisive and learning fast.



Quadrant 1

Urgent + Important

Do it now (crisis, deadlines)



Quadrant 2

Not Urgent + Important

Schedule it (strategy, development)



Quadrant 3

Urgent + Not Important

Delegate it (interruptions, some emails)



Quadrant 4

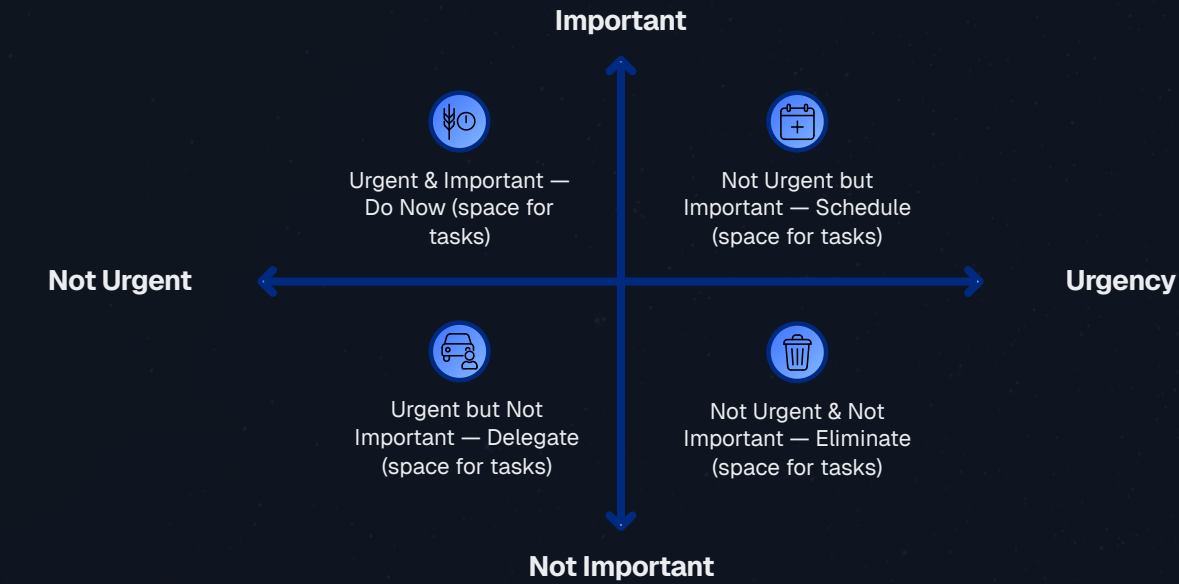
Not Urgent + Not Important

Eliminate it (time wasters, busy work)

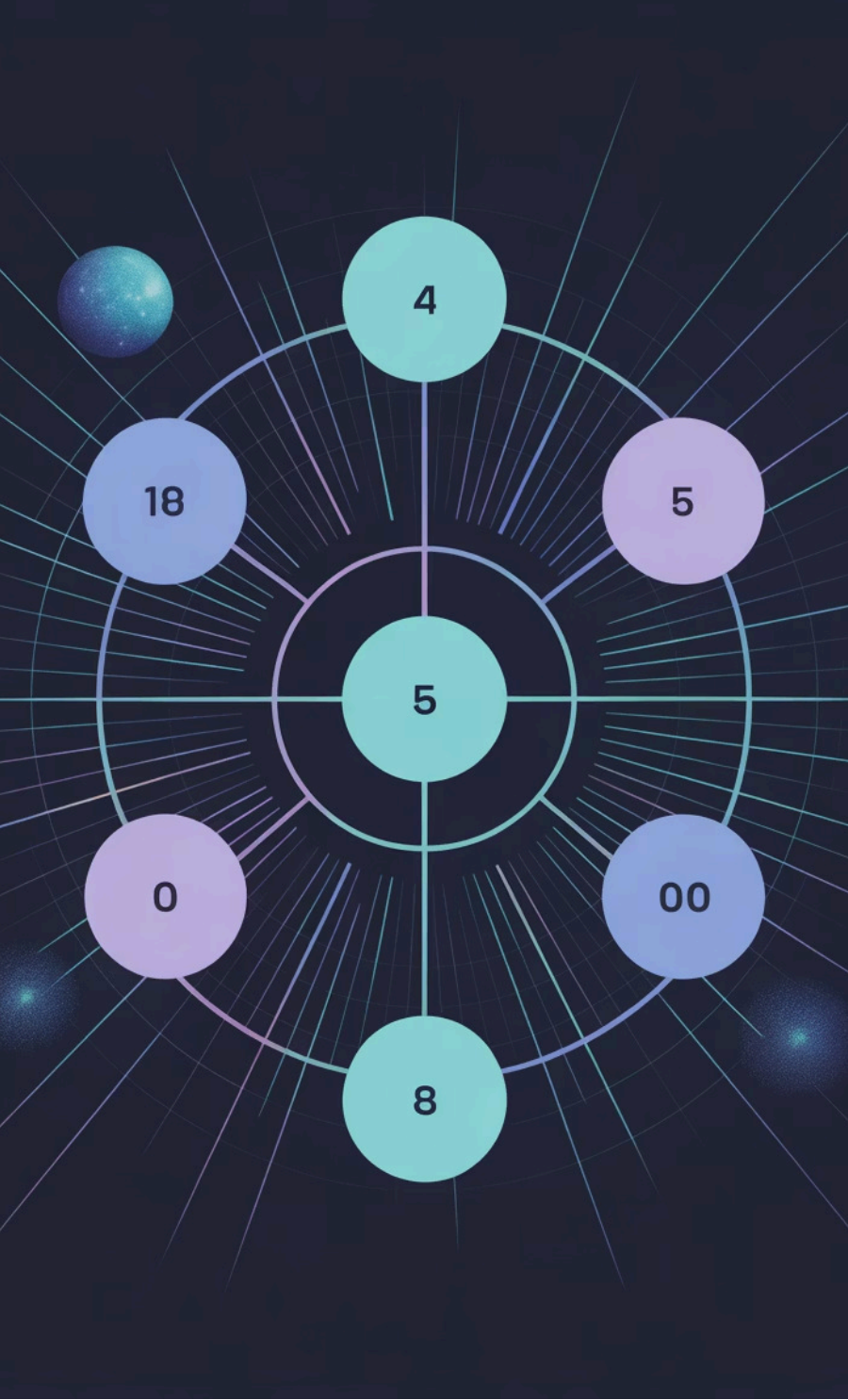
The Eisenhower Matrix™ - Spend 80% of your time in Quadrant 2. That's where leadership happens.

Prioritize Your Week

List everything on your plate this week. Categorize each item using the Eisenhower Matrix to gain clarity on where to focus your energy.



What will you eliminate or delegate?



The Accountability System: Driving Results

Accountability is not punishment. It's clarity. When expectations are clear and consequences are consistent, people thrive. When they're ambiguous, people flounder. Your job is to create a culture where accountability is expected, not feared.

1	Clear Expectations What does success look like?
2	Agreed Timeline When will it be done?
3	Defined Metrics How will we measure it?
4	Regular Check-Ins How often will we review progress?
5	Consequences What happens if it's done? What happens if it's not?



Create an Accountability Agreement

Choose a project or goal for one of your team members. Complete this agreement to ensure crystal-clear expectations and mutual commitment.

Clear Expectation

What does success look like?

Timeline

When will it be done?

Metrics

How will we measure it?

Check-Ins

How often will we review?

Consequences

Positive and negative:



The Conflict Resolution Framework

Conflict is not the problem. Unresolved conflict is. Great leaders don't avoid conflict—they lean into it. They see it as an opportunity to build trust, clarify values, and strengthen relationships.

1

Listen to Understand

(not to respond)

"Tell me your perspective."

"What's most important to you here?"

2

Find Common Ground

(shared goals or values)

"We both want [shared goal]. Can we agree on that?"

3

Co-Create the Solution

(involve them in the answer)

"What would a win-win solution look like?"

"How can we move forward together?"

